

HR-202 Annual Leave

Policy ID: HR-202 Version: 2.4 Classification: Internal
Effective Date: 1 January 2026 Owner: People Operations
Applies to: All permanent and fixed-term employees

1 Purpose and Scope

This policy explains how much annual leave employees receive, how leave is accrued, and the process for requesting and taking it. Taking leave is encouraged: rest is a condition of sustainable performance, not a reward for it.

2 Annual Leave

2.1 Entitlement

Full-time employees receive twenty-five days of paid annual leave per leave year, in addition to public holidays. Part-time employees receive a pro-rata entitlement based on their contracted hours. Employees receive one additional day of leave for every three complete years of continuous service, to a maximum of five additional days.

2.2 Accrual

Leave accrues monthly at one twelfth of the annual entitlement. New joiners accrue from their start date and may take accrued leave during their probationary period with their manager's approval.

2.3 The Leave Year

The leave year runs from the first of January to the thirty-first of December. Entitlement is reset at the start of each leave year.

2.4 Requesting and Taking Annual Leave

All annual leave must be requested through the human resources system and approved by the employee's manager before any travel or other commitment is booked. Leave taken without prior approval is treated as unauthorised absence under the attendance policy.

Requests must be submitted at least fourteen calendar days before the first day of leave. For a continuous absence of more than five working days, the request must be submitted at least twenty-eight calendar days in advance. Managers will respond to a request within five working days of receiving it. Requests are considered in the order they are received. A manager may decline a request where the absence would leave the team without adequate cover, where it falls in a published critical period such as a financial close, or where the notice given is shorter than this policy requires. A declined request must be explained in writing, and the manager should offer alternative dates.

A continuous absence of more than ten working days additionally requires approval from the relevant director. Employees are asked to take at least ten days of their entitlement as a single continuous period during the leave year.

2.5 Carry Over

Up to five days of unused annual leave may be carried into the next leave year and must be taken by the thirty-first of March. Leave beyond five days is lost at the end of the leave year unless the employee was prevented from taking it by long-term sickness or family leave.

3 Public Holidays

Employees receive the public holidays that apply in their country of employment. Where an employee is required to work a public holiday, an equivalent day off in lieu is granted.

4 Leave on Termination

On termination of employment, accrued but untaken leave is paid in the final salary payment. Where an employee has taken more leave than accrued, the excess is deducted from the final payment.